

U.S. District Court for the District of Colorado.

Tewksbury, R., & Demichele, M. (2006). Porn in prison. *Journal of Offender Rehabilitation*, 42(2), 35–48.

Torrey, M. (1992). We get the message: Pornography in the workplace *Southwestern University Law Review*, 22(53), 53–103.

Sight and Sound of Juvenile Offenders

In practice “sight and sound” restrictions are results of a 1974 federally established standard for the care of noncriminal status offenders and nonoffenders under the custody of juvenile justice authorities. In brief, juveniles detained under state custody or while being processed within the juvenile justice system in an adult facility should not have contact with adult inmates.

Historically, in the United States the practice of separating children from adults in custody can be traced to the humanist efforts of the child-saving movements during the late 19th and early 20th centuries. Socially progressive reforms were motivated by the belief that children should be protected from the predatory victimizations that can occur while incarcerated with adults, and that early intervention improves societies’ chances of reducing future crime by resocializing young delinquents and status offenders. As a result of reported abuses and the number of juveniles in adult facilities, the federal government established various committees and legislation to address the needs of justice and delinquency prevention programs at the state level. Over a century of reforms, state-based policy adaptations, and Supreme Court decisions have culminated in the Juvenile Justice Delinquency and Prevention Act (JJDP) of 1974, including its sight and sound provisions.

The JJDP coalesced federal funding for a state’s juvenile justice system to compliance with four federal core requirements addressing the safety of juveniles while in custody. The core protections do not apply to juveniles remanded to an adult criminal court.

The JJDP carries two provisions attached to sight and sound restrictions: First, the sight and sound separation stipulates that juveniles in custody will not come into contact with adult inmates during confinement or detention and clarifies that unintentional interaction in nonresidential areas is not a violation of the act. Second, the jail and lockup provision establishes that juveniles will not be detained or confined in any adult facility. There are exemptions: if the juvenile has been adjudicated and convicted as an adult, confinement of juveniles and adults in the same facility is permitted.

Other provisional exceptions for rural facilities meeting legislative requirements (e.g., if no visual contact or verbal communication is possible) are applicable during temporary holding or confinement situations when juveniles are awaiting institutional transfers and/or court appearances.

Jesus A. Garcia

See also: [Fathers behind Bars](#); [State-Raised Youths](#); [Tests of Adult Basic Education](#)

Further Reading

Cate, S. (2016). Devolution, not decarceration: The limits of juvenile justice reform in Texas. *Punishment and Society*, 18(5), 578–609.

Kolivoski, K. M., & Shook, J. J. (2016). Incarcerating juveniles in adult prisons. *Criminal Justice and Behavior*, 43(9), 1242–1259.

McCord, J., Widom, C. S., & Nancy, N. (Eds.). (2001). *Juvenile crime, juvenile justice. Panel on juvenile crime: Prevention, treatment, & control*. Washington, DC: National Academy Press.

Zane, S. N., Welsh, B. C., & Drakulich, K. M. (2016). Assessing the impact of race on the juvenile waiver decision: A systematic review and meta-analysis. *Journal of Criminal Justice*, 46, 106–117.

Snitches

Snitches or informants are individuals who provide information to persons in positions of power. Famous informants range from Judas Iscariot, who betrayed Jesus for 30 pieces of silver to Linda Tripp who supplied information used to assist in the impeachment proceedings of President Bill Clinton. Although there is an abundance of literature related to the role of informants in policing, very little literature relates to informants in prisons and jails. Some researchers have alluded to the “jailhouse snitch,” a prisoner (often a pretrial detainee) who befriends another prisoner for the purpose of supplying criminal justice officials with information that can be

used as evidence in a future trial. Often, this type of inmate informant will be given some type of incentive (e.g., reduction in charges) for turning on his fellow prisoner. For this reason, both judges and jury members may be reluctant to accept testimony from a “jailhouse snitch.”

In his book *The Warehouse Prison*, the late John Irwin, an inmate turned professor, argues that the convict code socializes inmates not to inform on other offenders and also to avoid cooperating with corrections staff. This is consistent with Gresham Sykes’s classic ethnographic study of prison life. Sykes argues that “center men,” inmates who align themselves with correctional officers, are often expected to provide information to prison authorities, and as a result, tend to be detested by other inmates. Indeed, there is evidence that, in some cases, it can be hazardous for a prisoner to inform on other prisoners. This danger is reflected in the case of the 1980 New Mexico prison riot, where 33 inmate informants were murdered by other prisoners, in what has been referred to by penologists as the bloodiest prison riot in U.S. history.

In spite of the norms against “snitching,” some research reveals that this behavior may be rampant within prisons and jails. For example, James Marquart and Julian Roebuck describe how Texas